

O Living Bread from Heaven

- 1 O Living Bread from heaven,
how hast thou fed thy guest!
The gifts thou now hast given
have filled my heart with rest.
O wondrous food of blessing,
O cup that heals our woes,
my heart, this gift possessing,
in thankful song o'erflows.
- 2 My Lord, thou here hast led me
within thy holiest place,
and there thyself hast fed me
with treasures of thy grace;
and thou hast freely given
what earth could never buy,
the Bread of Life from heaven,
that now I shall not die.
- 3 Thou givest all I wanted,
the food can death destroy;
and thou hast freely granted
the cup of endless joy.
And Lord, I do not merit
the favor thou hast shown,
and all my soul and spirit
bow down before thy throne.
- 4 Lord, grant me that, thus strengthened
with heav'nly food, while here
my course on earth is lengthened,
I serve with holy fear;
and when thou call'st my spirit
to leave this world below,
I enter, through thy merit,
where joys unmingled flow.

Words: Johann Rist, 1651; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1858
Music: Welsh hymn melody; William Lloyd, 1840; alt.
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